Q2FY26 REVIEW

SECTOR UPDATE

nuvama institutional equities

HV T&D margins soar; non-power lags

Q2FY26 showed a clear split: T&D/HVDC players posted execution/OI rise of 28%/17% and OPM expansion of 640bp versus 9%/3%/-210bp for non-Power Industrials. HV T&D (*GVT&D, Hitachi Energy, CG Power*) and BTG (*BHE*L) rode strong thermal/RE-driven T&D orders while non-Power T&D names (ABB, SIEM) reported selective growth (exhibit 1).

We stay optimistic on Thermal BTG + T&D capex. Broad-based private capex remains patchy, concentrated in data centres, EVs and semiconductors while order recovery in railways is a key monitorable (ABB, Cummins). While the worst may be over for TMX, we await traction in OIs and execution before turning positive. Top picks: BHEL, Hitachi Energy, GVTD and CG Power.

Multi-year high OBs underpin visibility; monsoons delay execution

India's capex cycle is underpinned by the planned INR9.15tn Power T&D outlay over 2022–32—including eight–ten HVDC corridors (equipment awards completed for two)—and strong exports (25–30% OB for most players). Non-power OI is driven by new-age sectors such as data centres, EV/battery, semiconductors and electronics while traditional factory capex stays muted. The RBI's CUF at 77.7% *(> 75% for ten–12 consecutive quarters)* marks a decadal-high and may signal a turning point for private capex. We stay watchful on whether GoI's measures (tax cuts, GST reforms, PLIs, rate cuts, liquidity support) can trigger a broader sustained private- investment cycle beyond the current pockets *(H1FY26 BSE500 capex still at only 4% YoY)*.

Q2FY26 review: Power equipment players across the HV value chain continue to operate with multi-year-high backlogs (INR10.8tn, +28% YoY) ensuring strong revenue visibility. HV T&D bucket delivered OI/sales growth of 17.1%/28.1% along with 640bp margin expansion to average OPM of 19.8%. In contrast, the non-power industrial and railways bucket (ABB, Siemens, CG Power industrials segment and Thermax) reported OI/sales growth of 3.0%/8.5% and -210bp margin decline with average OPM at 11.4%. Extended monsoons temporarily slowed site work, deferring execution into H2.

HV bucket sees OPM expansion (by 640bp YoY) aided by better pricing, richer product mix, rising exports mix and operational efficiencies (see exhibit). HVDC ordering has accelerated and should remain robust over the next three–five years *(Khavda–South Olepad awarded to Adani group; Barmer–South Kalamb ordering likely by Q4FY26/Q1FY27 — equipment orders for both still pending).*

Premium valuations stay justified, in our view, as all-time-high order books and rising margins translate into strong earnings CAGRs and robust RoEs (see exhibit). We stay bullish on high growth pockets—thermal, nuclear and T&D/HVDC—where big-ticket orders could materialise over the next six–18 months, supported by India's power generation and transmission capex super-cycle. We remain watchful, however, on signs of a broader, multi-year private-investment cycle taking shape.

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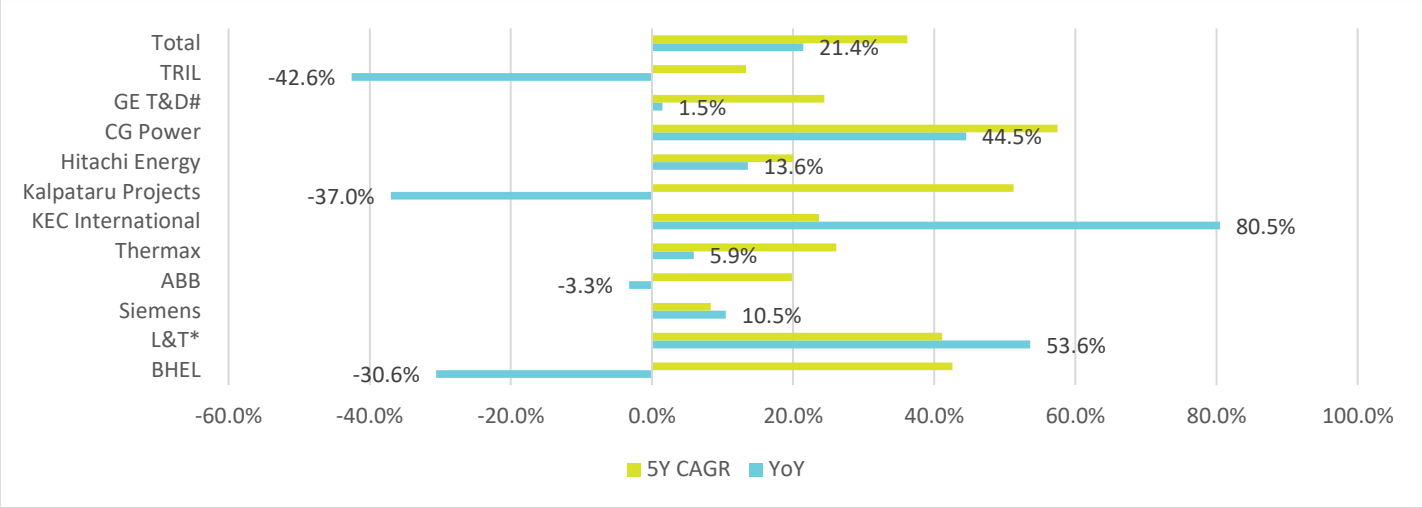
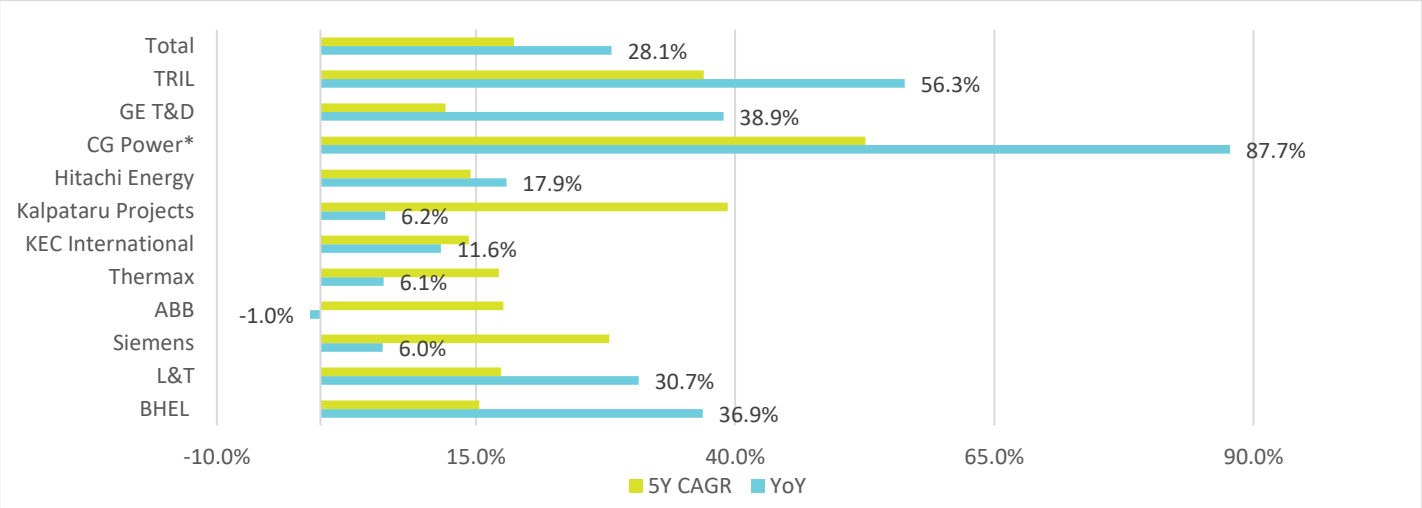
Focus charts

Exhibit 1: Q2FY26 OI YoY growth and 5Y CAGR – technology-enabled power equipment companies leading the pack



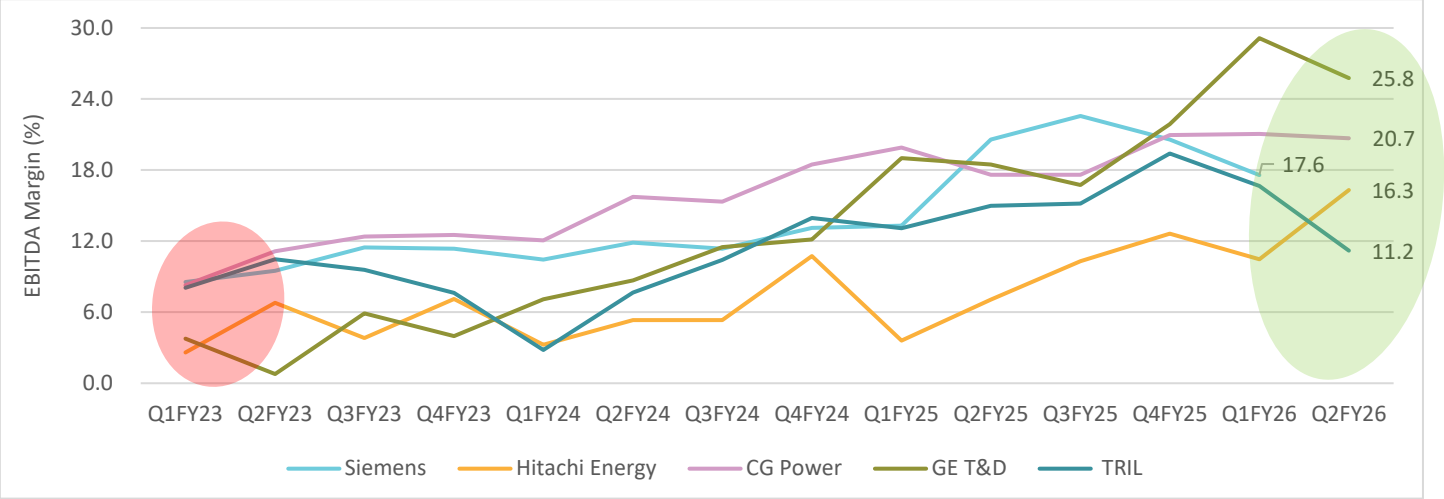
*Source: Company, Nuvama Research. *L&T core order inflow. #OI growth adjusted for INR31bn large orders received last year.*

Exhibit 2: Q2FY26 order book growth – YoY and 5Y CAGR



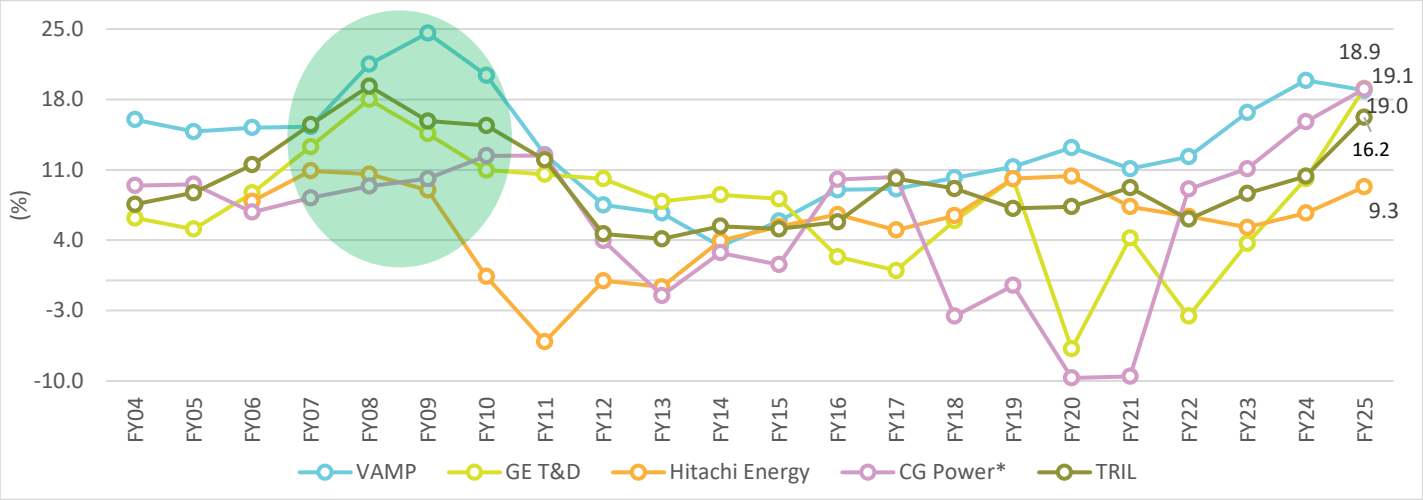
*Source: Company, Nuvama Research. *4Y CAGR*

Exhibit 3: EBITDA margin uptick across HV power T&D product players justifies capex super-cycle at play



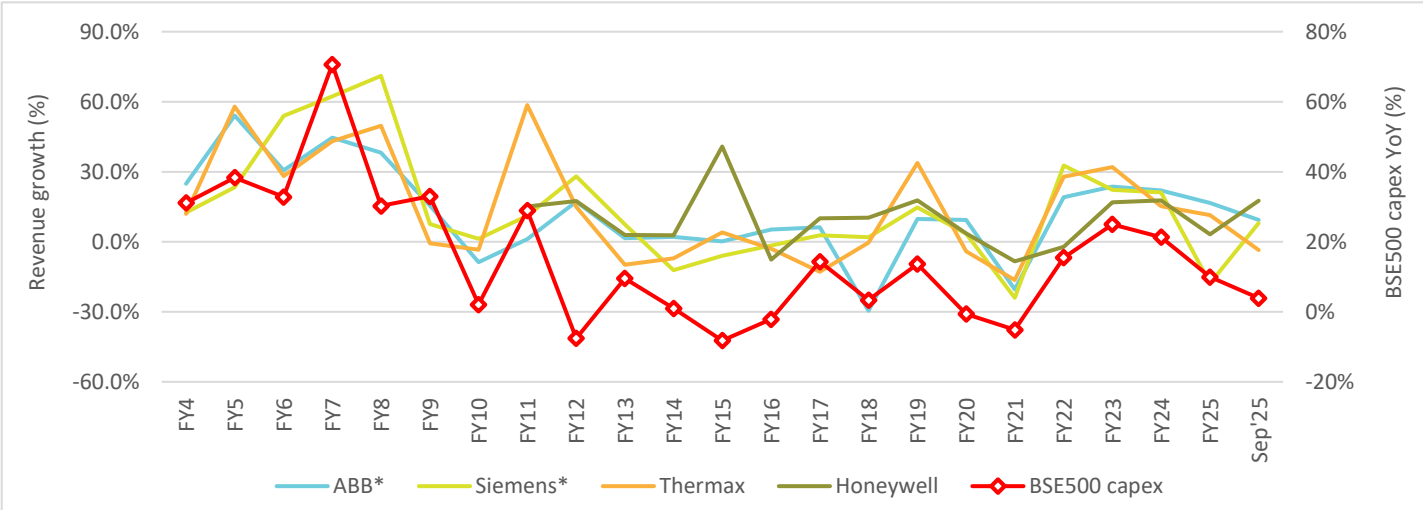
Source: Company, Nuvama Research. Note: For Siemens (energy biz) and CG Power (power segment) - EBIT margins have been considered.

Exhibit 4: Capex super-cycle spurs increase in EBITDA margins of transformer players



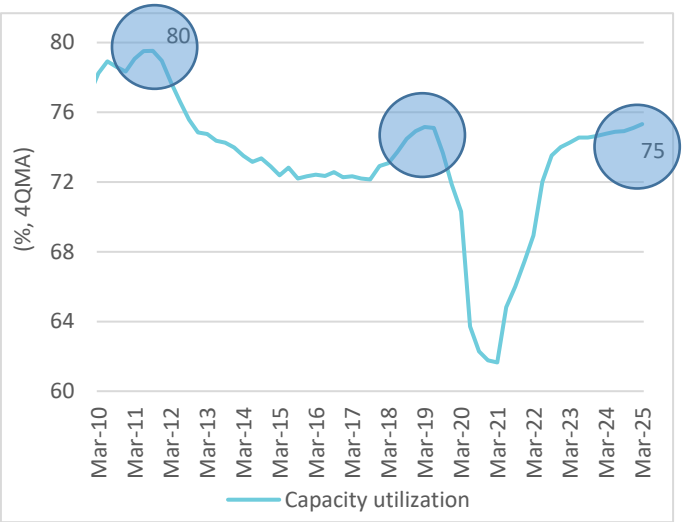
*Source: Bloomberg, Company, Nuvama Research. *CG Power's power segment EBIT margin has been considered.*

Exhibit 5: Non-power industrial stocks growth muted due to subdued private capex



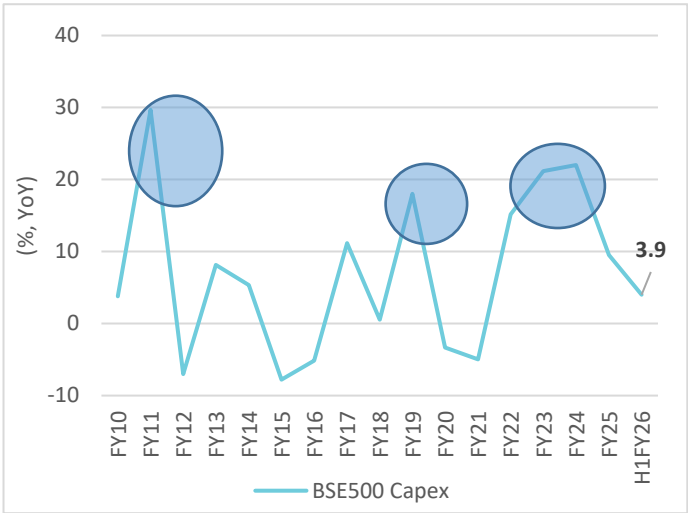
*Source: Company, Nuvama Research. *For ABB, FY25 aligns with CY24, while for Siemens, FY25 has been treated as FY24; the same convention is applied for all years to ensure comparability.*

Exhibit 6: RBI industry CUF ~77.7% on Mar-25 (decadal high)



Source: CMIE, Nuvama Research

Exhibit 7: BSE500 capex (growth picks up when CUF>75%)



Source: Bloomberg, Company, Nuvama Research

Exhibit 8: Data centres, Electronics, RE — only pockets of high growth (ABB Q3CY25 ppt)

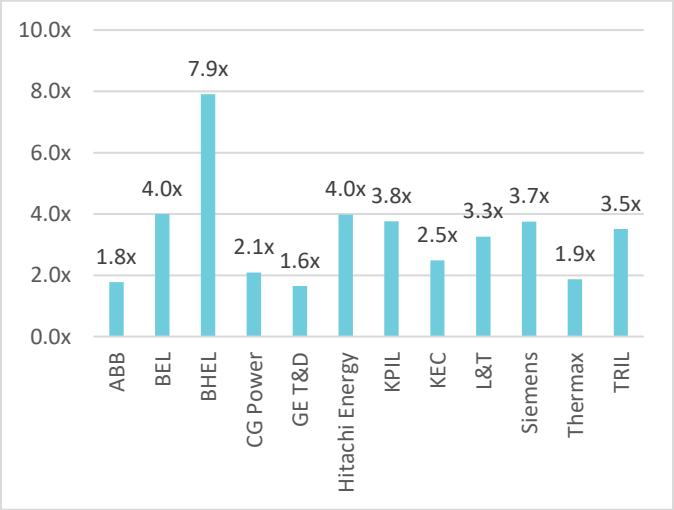
Source: ABB, Nuvama Research

Exhibit 9: Industrials and Railways versus Power Gen + T&D

	Revenues		OPMs		PAT	
Industrials + Railways	**FY22-25 CAGR (%)**	**YoY growth % (FY25)**	**Avg. FY22-25**	**FY25**	**FY22-25 CAGR (%)**	**YoY growth % (FY25)**
ABB	20.7%	16.7%	13.1%	18.9%	65.8%	50.2%
CG Power *	17.3%	17.4%	11.7% **	9.6% **	-	-
Cummins	19.0%	15.4%	17.5%	20.0%	36.2%	14.6%
Honeywell Automation	12.4%	3.2%	14.6%	14.0%	15.6%	4.4%
L&T	17.8%	15.7%	11.0%	10.3%	19.3%	12.3%
Siemens (ex-energy) ^	-	-0.2%	-	11.1%	-	-26.5%
Thermax	19.2%	11.4%	7.9%	8.7%	26.1%	10.4%
Power Gen + T&D						
APAR Ind.	25.9%	15.0%	8.1%	8.3%	47.3%	-0.5%
BHEL	10.1%	18.6%	3.6%	4.4%	7.7%	97.4%
CG Power #	32.3%	35.1%	11.9% **	17.0% **	-	-
GE T&D	11.9%	35.5%	7.3%	19.1%	78.2%	236.0%
Hitachi	9.3%	21.9%	6.9%	9.3%	31.8%	134.4%
KEC	16.7%	9.7%	6.1%	6.9%	15.0%	64.6%
KPIL	14.7%	13.7%	8.2%	8.2%	16.7%	5.1%
TARIL	20.4%	56.0%	10.3%	16.2%	147.1%	374.2%

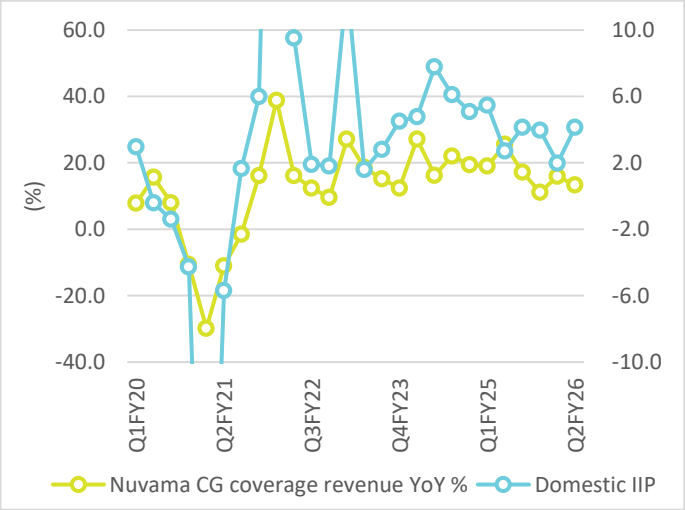
*Source: Company, Nuvama Research. Note: GE T&D's CAGR is calculated for FY21-25 given FY22 PAT was negative. *CG Power's industrial segment OI, #CG Power's power segment OI, ** EBIT margins considered for CG Power, ^Siemens is H1FY25 YoY data considered given de-merger of energy segment.*

Exhibit 10: Book-to-bill rate across our coverage (end-FY25)



Source: Company, Nuvama Research

Exhibit 11: Quarterly OI and revenue growth at end-Q2FY26



Source: Company, Nuvama Research

Exhibit 12: Peer valuations

Equities	FY28E PE	Nuvama Target multiple	EPS CAGR (FY25-28E)	Median ROE (FY26-28E)
TRIL	23.3	25.0x	24.2%	20.2%
Hitachi Energy	**50.8**	**60.0x**	**72.3%**	**24.4%**
CG Power	**50.6**	**60.0x**	**30.8%**	**20.6%**
Kalpataru Projects	13.3	20.0x	42.3%	15.9%
BHEL	**20.4**	**25.0x**	**111.7%**	**14.9%**
Larsen & Toubro*	**18.5**	**25.0x**	**27.3%**	**20.3%**
ABB India#	54.1	55.0x	2.5%	21.7%
Siemens	48.3	45.0x	15.9%	15.0%
Cummins India	40.2	45.0x	16.5%	26.7%
GE T&D	**50.1**	**60.0x**	**37.2%**	**43.4%**
Thermax	29.4	36.0x	21.9%	15.0%
KEC International#	15.8	18.0x	44.0%	16.9%
Suzlon	26.4	40.0x	21.2%	29.5%
Inox Wind	21.5	30.0x	64.9%	13.9%

Source: Nuvama Research. *Assigning 25x to L&T core biz, #FY27 PE, EPS CAGR, RoE

Exhibit 13: Equities performance of Nuvama Industrials coverage

Companies	1W	1M	3M	6M	1YR	3YR	5YR	10YR
ABB	5%	-1%	1%	-10%	-24%	67%	362%	388%
BEL	1%	2%	14%	17%	54%	302%	1077%	1020%
BHEL	2%	23%	30%	18%	26%	299%	885%	145%
Cummins	0%	9%	15%	48%	33%	231%	757%	334%
CG Power	-3%	-2%	7%	5%	2%	170%	2006%	1033%
GV T&D	-1%	4%	10%	72%	63%	2319%	2925%	542%
Honeywell	-2%	-4%	-9%	-6%	-16%	-14%	13%	276%
L&T	1%	4%	12%	13%	16%	100%	256%	342%
KEC	-10%	-17%	-14%	-10%	-29%	72%	103%	361%
KPIL	-1%	-3%	-4%	10%	7%	141%	298%	387%
Siemens	5%	4%	2%	3%	-2%	131%	355%	423%
Thermax	-2%	-6%	-8%	-15%	-32%	40%	253%	237%
Hitachi Energy	4%	28%	12%	41%	96%	675%	2225%	3031%
TARIL	8%	-35%	-37%	-39%	-31%	1016%	6221%	3323%
Skipper	3%	-4%	-10%	0%	-8%	488%	836%	195%
BSE Cap Goods Index	0%	2%	5%	4%	7%	112%	317%	388%

Source: Bloomberg, Nuvama Research

Sectors building the path ahead

India's manufacturing sector contributes to 17% of GDP (vis-a-vis *services at 55%*) making India the sixth largest manufacturing economy globally though contributing only 3.1% to the world GDP - *leaving substantial headroom for growth*. RBI's capacity utilisation rate at 77.7% (*versus peak at 80%-plus levels during 2003–09*) has reached pre-covid levels, but still has some way to go to reach previous cycle's peak.

We believe major reforms of the past decade, "*Make in India", Unified Payments Interface (UPI)', Real Estate Regulatory Authority (RERA), Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC), Goods & Services Tax (GST), Production Linked Incentives (PLI) scheme, China + 1* etc., —have collectively laid the groundwork for improved credit lending by strengthening corporate balance sheets, enhancing capital availability, and reducing receivable cycles."

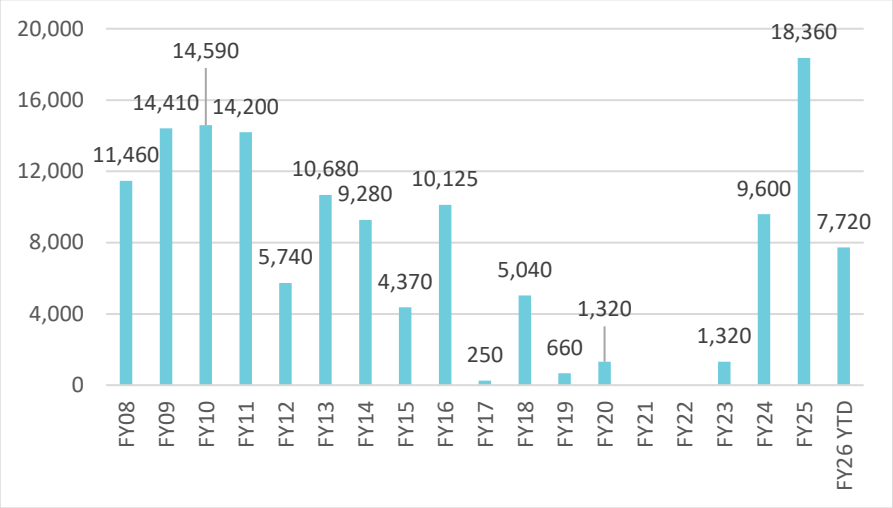
Investment opportunities span well-defined themes—Power (generation, RE, T&D), Defence, Electronics Manufacturing, the EV ecosystem, Energy Transition, Data Centres—each reinforcing India's manufacturing momentum. We remain watchful on whether GoI's measures (tax cuts, GST reforms, PLIs, rate cuts and liquidity support) can trigger a broader sustained private—investment cycle beyond the current pockets *(H1FY26 BSE500 capex still at only 4% YoY).*

Power Generation (Thermal/RE)

Peak deficit here/base deficit not far away

- India is already facing peak deficit in peak summers and evenings (when solar goes off grid).
- In order to meet 6% power demand growth—supply growth from RE has to be 40–50GW yearly and Thermal at 10–15GW yearly.
- If demand growth is slower at 5–6% the problem gets delayed to FY30–32 but not eliminated, hence the urgency to add both RE and Thermal.

Exhibit 14: BHEL thermal annual order inflows (MW)



Source: Company, Nuvama Research

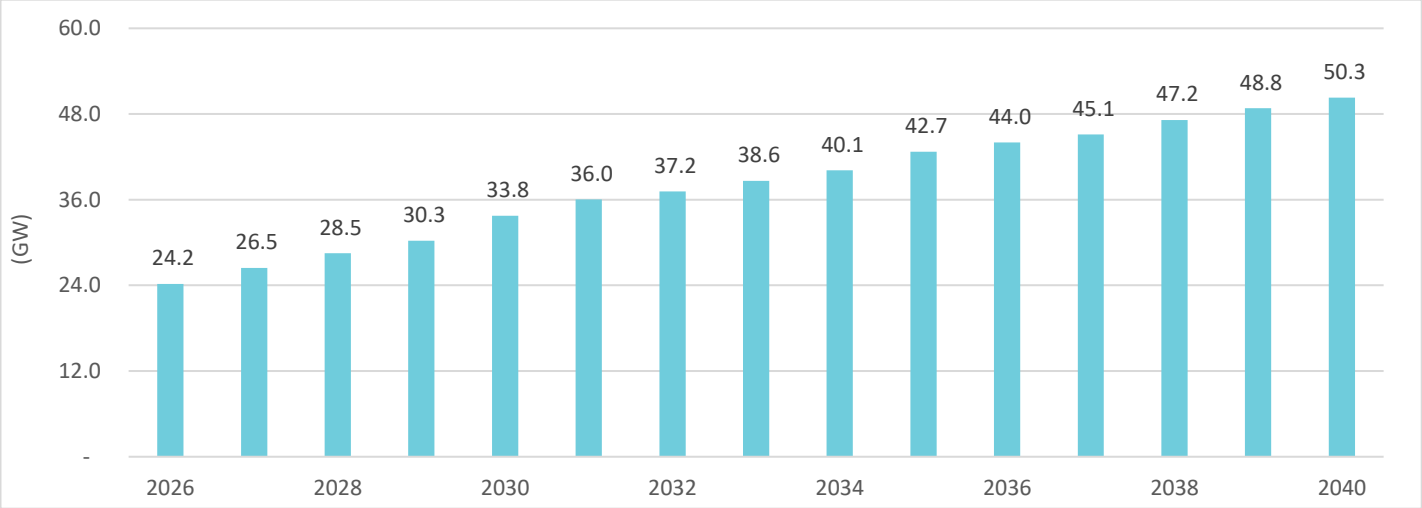
Exhibit 15: Thermal pipeline as per CEA (~18.4GW awarded to BHEL in FY25)

Thermal pipeline as per CEA – yet to be awarded

Name of project	State	Sector	Total capacity (MW)	Total MW	Size (INR bn)	Developer	Expected ordering timeline
Yet to be awarded							
List of candidate coal plants for likely benefits during 2022-32							
TPS-II 2ND EXPANSION	TAMIL NADU	CENTRAL	2X660=1320	1,320	86	NLC India	FY24 (in advanced stages of commissioning)
DURGAPUR TPS	WEST BENGAL	CENTRAL	800	800	52	DVC	Not begun the permitting process
MEJA-II	UTTAR PRADESH	CENTRAL	2X660=1320	1,320	86	NTPC	FY24
BUXAR	BIHAR	CENTRAL	1X660=660	660	43	SJVN	Beyond FY25
CHANDRAPURA	MAHARASHTRA	STATE	1X660=660	660	43	MSPGCL	Sanctioned. FY25 or beyond.
List of additional candidate coal plants for development in future during 2022-32							
NLC TALABIRA STPS, SAMBALPUR,ODISHA	ODISHA	CENTRAL	1X800=800	800	52	NLC India	Beyond FY25
MBPP SUNDERGARH	ODISHA	CENTRAL	2X800=1600	1,600	104	PFC	Beyond FY25
GODHNA TPS, CHAMPA	KARNATAKA	CENTRAL	2X800=1600	1,600	104	NTPC	Beyond FY25
CHHABRA TPS U#7 & 8	RAJASTHAN	CENTRAL	2X660=1320	1,320	86	RVUN/NTPC	Terms of reference document was approved in Jun'23. Expected to be ordered out in FY24/25.
KALISINDH TPS	RAJASTHAN	CENTRAL	1X800=800	800	52	RVUN	Terms of reference document was approved in Mar'23. Expected to be ordered out in FY24/25.
UDANGUDI STPP II&III	TAMIL NADU	CENTRAL	2X660=1320	1,320	86	TANGEDCO	Beyond FY25
Total yet to be awarded				**12,200**			

Source: CEA, Company, Nuvama Research

Exhibit 16: Growing thermal replacement demand; plants >35 years at 37GW by FY32/50GW by FY40

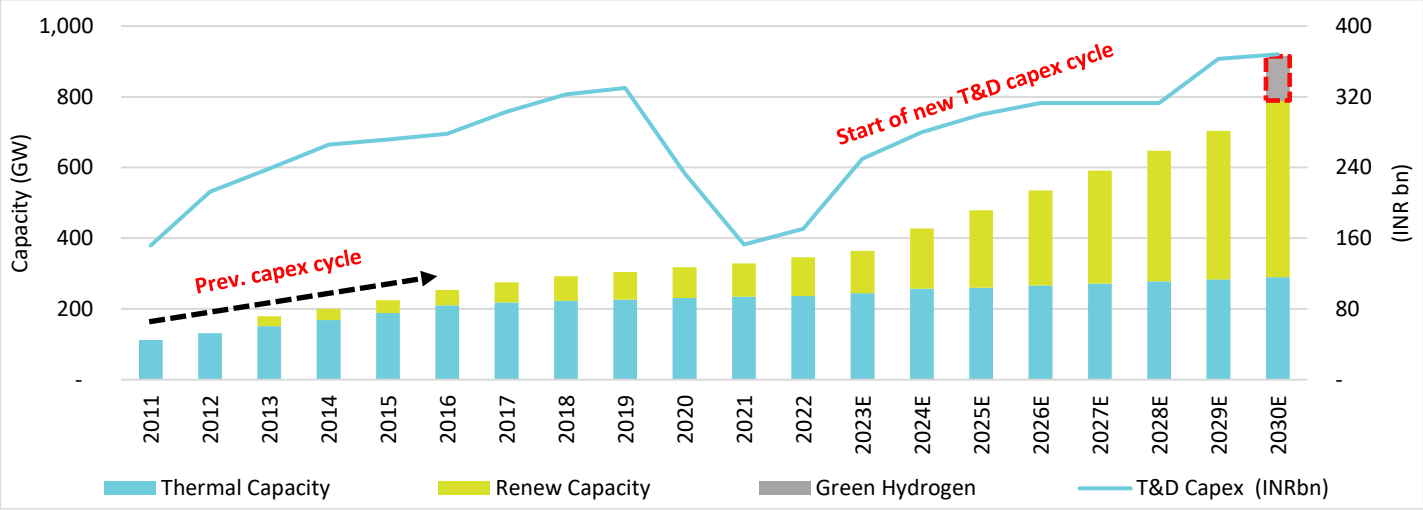


Source: Nuvama Research

Power Transmission & Distribution

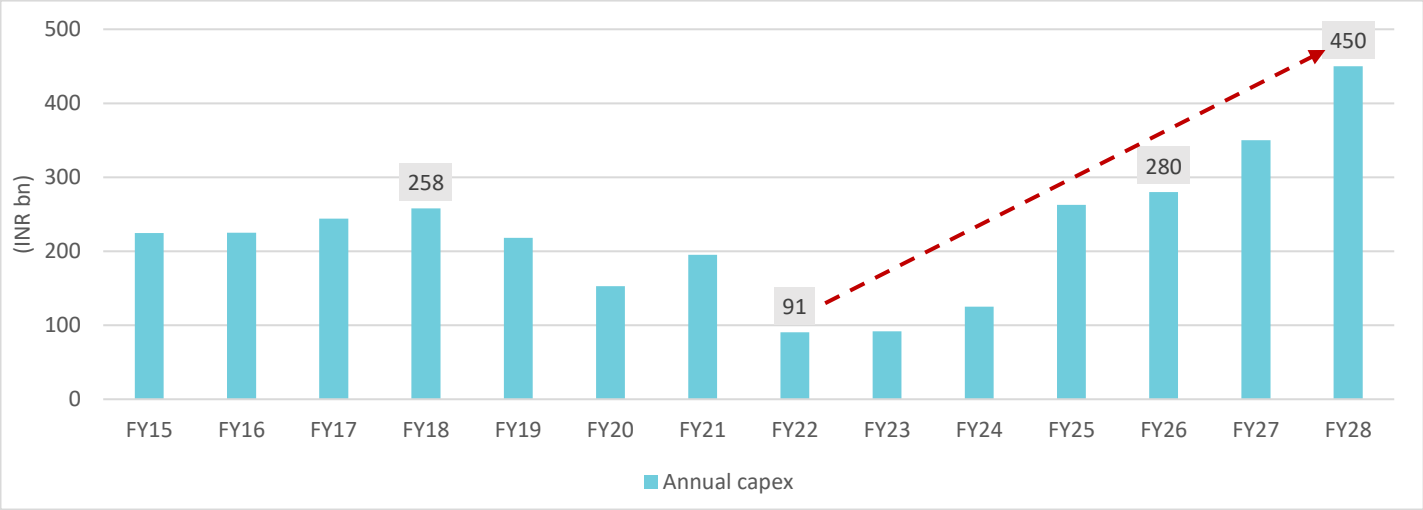
India's capex cycle is underpinned by the planned INR9.15tn Power T&D outlay over 2022–32—including 8–10 HVDC corridors (equipment awards completed for two)—and strong exports (25–30% OB for most players).

Exhibit 17: Renewables capex to spur next cycle of T&D capex (interstate)



Source: Nuvama Research

Exhibit 18: PGCIL's capex to grow 2–3x, assuming 40–50% share of INR9.15tn capex



Source: PGCIL, Nuvama Research

HVDC mega opportunity

India plans to add *eight to ten large HVDC projects*, each worth ~ INR150–200bn, of which the product supply is likely to be around 40–50%. With only three players who can deliver HVDC technology (**Siemens Energy, Hitachi Energy and GE Vernova T&D**) and large pipeline of projects up for grabs (exhibit 20), we find all three names benefitting from this opportunity.

Exhibit 19: Four–five HVDCs in near-term pipeline — to be ordered out over next two–three years

HVDC Projects	Technology	Size (MW)	Cost (INR bn)	Likely award	Comments
±800 kV Bhadla-III - Fatehpur HVDC line	LCC	6,000	200-250	FY24-25E	6,000MW, + 800 kV HVDC system between Bhadla-III and Fatehpur **Adani Group** won the project Equipment order placed to **Hitachi Energy**
±350kV Pang - Kaithal HVDC line (Leh Ladakh)	VSC	5,000	320	FY26-27E	- + 350kV, 5,000MW VSC-based HVDC link from Pang to Kaithal - Allocated to PGCIL in Jan'22 through RTM route - **Converted to HVAC**
±800kV Barmer-II - Jabalpur HVDC line	LCC	6,000	150-200	FY26-27E	- ±800kV HVDC line between Barmer-II (HVDC) -Jabalpur PS(~1,100km) - **Expected to see ordering in FY26/27E**
±800kV Khavda - Aurangabad HVDC line	LCC	8,000	200-250	FY24-25E	- Khavda – Aurangabad 8,000MW, ±800kV HVDC line - **PGCIL** won the project - Equipment order placed to **Hitachi Energy**
±500kV Khavda – South Olepad HVDC line	VSC	2,500	120-150	FY26-27E	- 2,500 MW HVDC system between KPS III and South Olepad - **Adani Group won the project**
Total		**25,000**	**990-1100**	**FY24-30E**	

Source: NEP, CEA, Nuvama Research. Note: Khavda and Bhadla HVDCs, both have been won by consortium of Hitachi Energy and BHEL.

Exhibit 20: HVDCs under planning

HVDC Projects	Technology	Cost (INR bn)	Size (MW)
Bikaner-Begunia (Rajasthan-Odisha)	LCC (±800 kV)	NA	6,000
Beawar (Rajasthan)	LCC (±800 kV)	NA	6,000
Paradeep – Andaman	VSC (±320 kV)	160	500
Sri-Lanka HVDC Phase I	VSC (±320 kV)	99	500
Lakadia–Alephata	*±800 kV LCC / ±600 kV VSC	NA	6,000

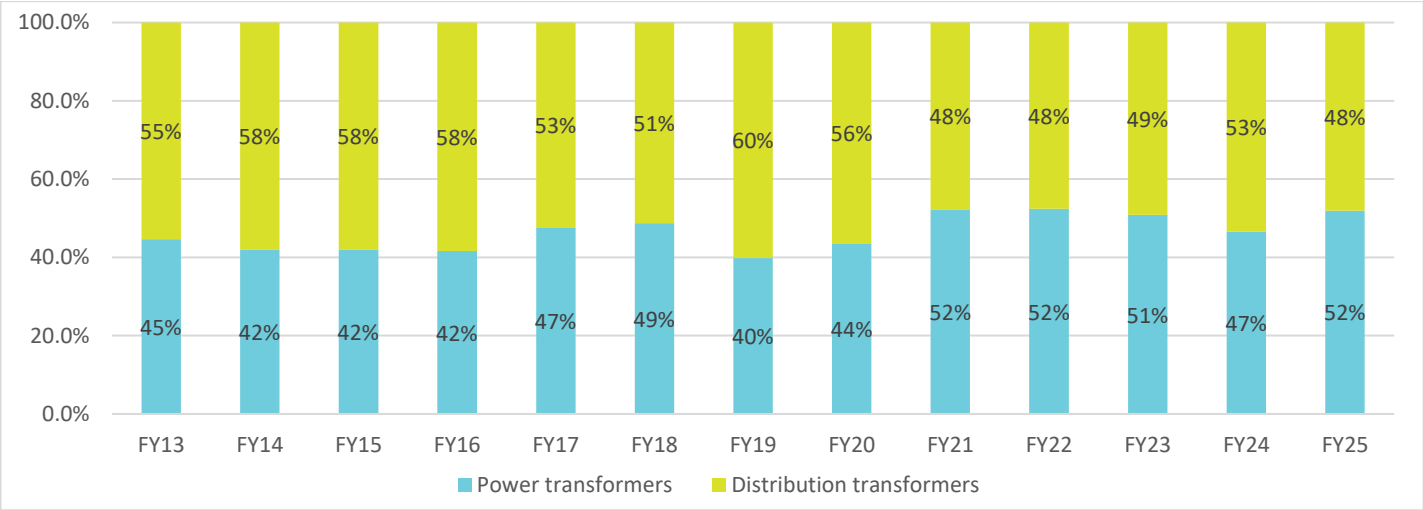
*Source: Nuvama Research. *Under discussions*

Exhibit 21: NEP's historical five-year plans – Addition of sub-stations

Sub-stations	Addition (in MVA)					*Growth rates (%)*				
NEP	HVDC	765kV	400kV	230/220kV	Total	HVDC	765kV	400kV	230/220kV	Total
6th plan (1980-85)	0	0	9,330	37,291	46,621					
7th plan (1985-90)	0	0	12,250	16,451	28,701			31.3%	-55.9%	-38.4%
8th plan (1992-97)	0	0	19,285	30,435	**49,720**			57.4%	85.0%	**73.2%**
9th plan (1997-2002)	5,000	0	19,515	32,186	56,701			1.2%	5.8%	14.0%
10th plan (2002-2007)	3,000	0	32,562	40,134	**75,696**	-40.0%		66.9%	24.7%	**33.5%**
11th Plan (2007-12)	1,750	25,000	58,085	67,277	**1,52,112**	-41.7%		78.4%	67.6%	**101.0%**
12th Plan (2012-17)	9,750	1,42,500	89,780	89,184	**3,31,214**	457.1%	470.0%	54.6%	32.6%	**117.7%**
13th Plan (2017-22)	14,000	89,700	1,52,306	1,07,679	3,63,685	43.6%	-37.1%	69.6%	20.7%	9.8%
14th Plan (2022-27)	12,000	3,19,500	2,68,135	1,23,305	**7,22,940**	-14.3%	256.2%	76.1%	14.5%	**98.8%**

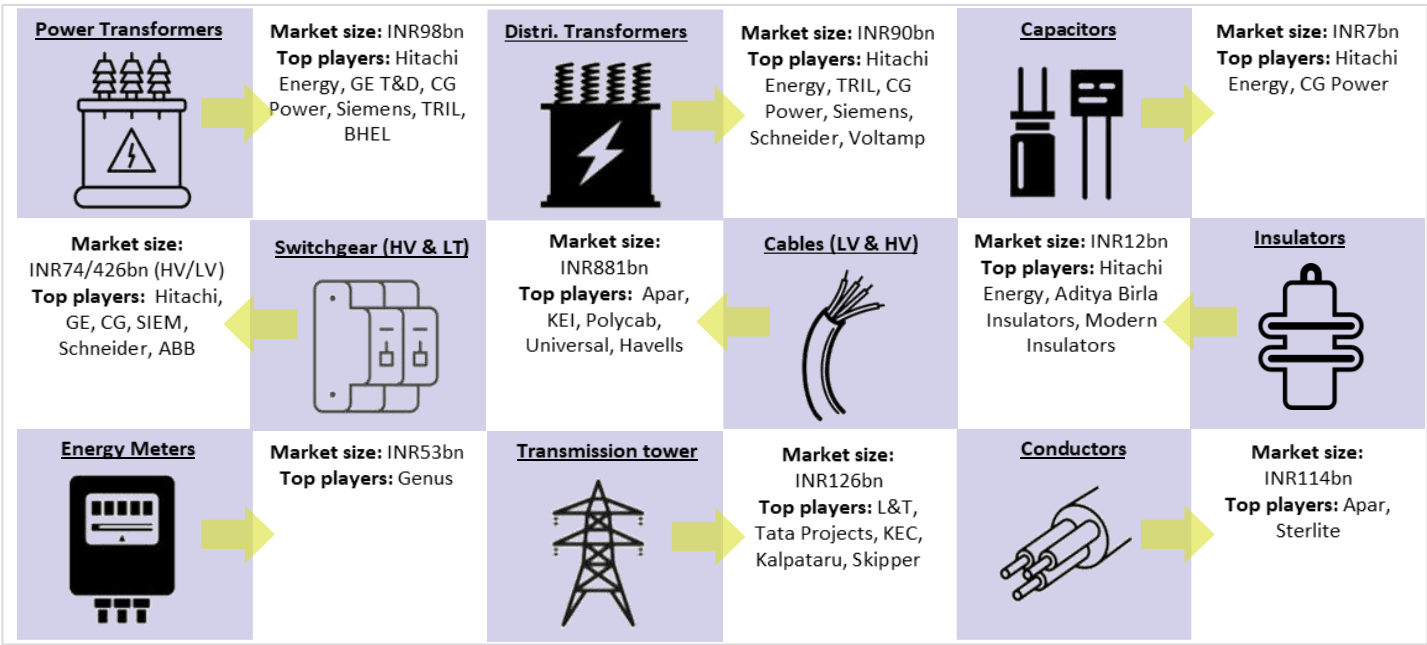
Source: NEP, Nuvama Research

Exhibit 22: PT mix (220-765KV) growing versus DT mix over last decade, market size as on FY25 at INR188bn



Source: IEEMA, Nuvama Research

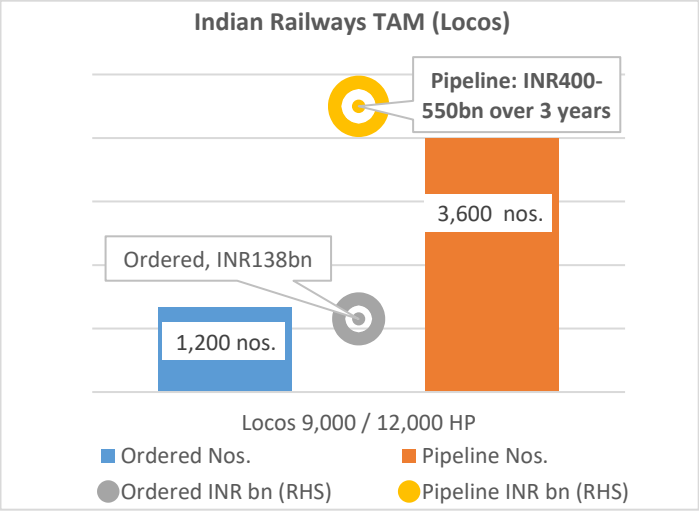
Exhibit 23: Value chain (FY25): Market size by product and top players thereof



Source: IEEMA, Nuvama Research

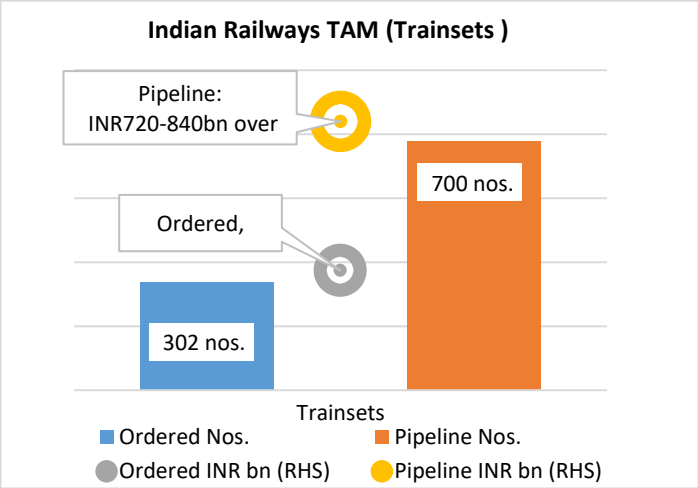
Railways/Metros

Exhibit 24: Locos TAM estimates at 3,600 (~INR400–550bn) over three years



Source: Nuvama Research

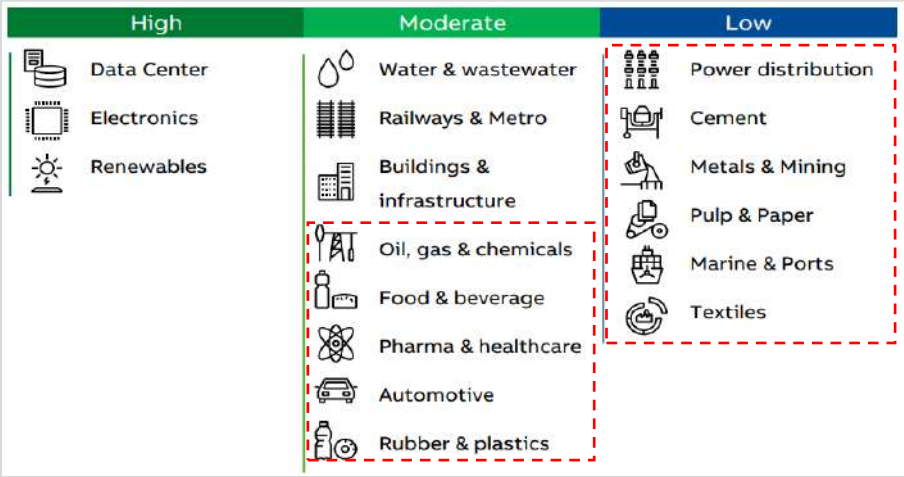
Exhibit 25: VB trainset TAM estimated at 700 (~INR720–840bn) over four–five years



Source: Nuvama Research

DC/Electronics/RE outpace traditional sectors

Exhibit 26: ABB Q3CY25 – Private capex in conventional areas yet to pick up



Source: ABB, Nuvama Research

All price charts cannot be included given the large of number of companies in our coverage. Specific charts may be available upon request.

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